GROUP OVERVIEW

Share Your Expertise. Sharpen Our Thinking.

Where Marketing Leaders Come Together to Learn, Share, and Grow

Brand Sharpener is a community of experienced marketing, insights, product, creative, and business leaders who come together to explore how AI is transforming marketing through practical insights, real-world applications, and peer-to-peer learning.

> ***"We champion the idea that the best ideas are sharpened through conversation."***

Why Present at Brand Sharpener?

We're always looking for experienced practitioners who are willing to share what they're learning—not polished keynotes or product pitches, but real experiences, practical frameworks, lessons learned, and emerging ideas that help fellow marketers grow. Our sessions are interactive, discussion-driven, and focused on meaningful conversations among peers.

Topics That Spark Great Conversations

TOPIC	EXAMPLES
AI & GenAI	Practical applications, workflow transformation, governance, emerging tools, and implementation lessons
Brand Strategy	Positioning, storytelling, differentiation, and transformation
Consumer Insights	Research, segmentation, journey mapping, and turning insights into action
Marketing Operations	MarTech, process improvement, campaign operations, and organizational effectiveness
Content & Creative	Content strategy, creative development, storytelling, creator partnerships, and campaigns
Analytics & Measurement	Attribution, dashboards, experimentation, KPIs, and business impact
Search & Discovery	SEO, GEO, discoverability, search behavior, and content optimization
Product & Innovation	Commercialization, go-to-market strategy, innovation, and customer adoption

What Makes a Great Session?

Practical business applications • Honest lessons learned • Real examples and demonstrations • Interactive discussion and audience participation • Actionable insights attendees can apply immediately

Speaker Experience

Format	20–45 minute virtual session — we leave room for discussion	**Audience**	Senior marketing, brand, insights, and business leaders, and practitioners
Style	Interactive discussion and audience Q&A, with an optional demo	**Promotion**	Featured across Brand Sharpener communications and LinkedIn community

Interested in Sharing What You're Learning?

If you have an idea that encourages thoughtful discussion, practical learning, and meaningful conversation, we'd love to hear from you.

Meet the Founders

Brand Sharpener was founded by experienced marketing, insights, and business leaders who believe the best ideas are sharpened through conversation. Together, we created a community where practitioners openly exchange ideas, explore emerging technologies, and learn from one another through practical, real-world experiences.

Stephen Griffiths FOUNDER

Managing Director

Director of Strategic Insights at Ameriprise Financial Services and a recognized insights leader focused on helping teams use data, research, and AI more effectively. Stephen also co-founded the Insights Career Network, a large volunteer-run community for market research and UX professionals, reflecting the community-building spirit behind Brand Sharpener.

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Jonathan Erickson CO-FOUNDER

Community & Communications Director

Insights and strategy leader whose work explores culture, research methodology, and the role of AI in strategic decision-making. Jonathan also co-founded the Third Culture Strategy & Insights Collective and brings a strong point of view on peer learning, cultural intelligence, and choosing the right tools for the problem.

jerickson87@gmail.com

Krysti Horvat CO-FOUNDER

Events & Membership Director

Creative designer and marketer whose work bridges brand, design, marketing, and emerging AI applications. Krysti brings a practitioner perspective to Brand Sharpener and a strong interest in how marketers can apply new tools in practical ways while continuing to learn from one another.

krysti401@gmail.com

Mary Rodgers CO-FOUNDER

Speaker & Partnership Director

Senior marketing executive with deep experience in brand strategy, go-to-market leadership, product commercialization, consumer insights, integrated marketing, and AI-enabled marketing. Mary has led marketing for major consumer and durable-goods businesses and brings a practical, business-outcome-focused perspective to the Brand Sharpener community.

mmargaretrodgers@gmail.com

Roxanna Kassamkara CO-FOUNDER

Brand Director

A Brand Sharpener co-founder who helps shape a community built around shared learning, candid discussion, and practical application. Her involvement reflects the group's commitment to bringing different practitioner perspectives together as marketing and AI continue to evolve.

rkassam@gmail.com

Justin Mancari CO-FOUNDER

Tech & Tools Director

Marketing and business development leader with experience spanning digital strategy, search, technology, and growth. Justin writes and speaks about the changing search landscape and how marketers can increase visibility across an expanding mix of channels, bringing a practical growth perspective to Brand Sharpener conversations.

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Connect With Us

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Interested in sharing your expertise? We'd love to start the conversation.

Brand Sharpener